

SEE TO AGAIN SEEK POLITICAL OFFICE

Montgomery Leader Speaker at Road Opening at Sycamore Landing.

BY WILLIAM S. TARVER, Staff Correspondent of The Star

SYCAMORE LANDING, Md., October 25.—E. Brooke Lee will be a candidate again for political office, he assured a crowd gathered here this afternoon for the formal opening of the road from Poolesville to this place.

Maj. Lee, the speaker of the Maryland House of Delegates and chairman of the Maryland Democratic Campaign Advisory Committee, is not a candidate for election November 4 and his statement today was the first public declaration that he will again seek office. He did not say for what office he intended to run in the future. Those close to the Montgomery County Democratic leader assert that he will devote much attention to State affairs in the future.

Discusses Political Situation.

The statement that he will be a candidate again came in the course of a discussion of the Montgomery County political situation.

"They tell me that I am an issue in this campaign," he declared. "Although I am not a candidate for any office, I have been the subject of many attacks and my political enemies had sought to defeat the Democratic administration candidates by striking at me. Let them have their say for me personally. My name will appear again on a ballot in Montgomery County and then they will have a chance to strike at me."

The road opening was celebrated with a barbecue given by Fred J. Hughes of Sycamore Landing. Frederick Stohman of Chevy Chase presided at the mass meeting, following the barbecue. The speakers included Representatives James W. Collier of Mississippi, Clagett Hillen, county commissioner, and Mr. Hughes.

Maj. Lee's address was concerned principally with predictions of the outcome of the coming election. Forty per cent of the Republicans in suburban Montgomery County, he declared, will vote for the Democratic candidates who will be elected by a majority of more than 2,000 votes.

Reliance on Colored Vote.

"The largest block of votes upon which the Republican county organization can depend," he said, "will be the 3,500 colored Republicans in the upper sections of the county. The two other large blocks of voters that the Republicans are hoping for on November 4 consist of a decidedly smaller number of white Republicans and a sizable number of Democratic voters who may follow their higher leaders into the Republican camp. It is hard to see how these three groups possibly can cooperate and work together during the next four years for the general advantage of the county."

Concerning the State campaign, Maj. Lee predicted that Gov. Albert C. Ritchie would be re-elected by a greater majority than in 1928 when he received 61,000 more votes than his Republican opponent.

"Well informed political observers in Baltimore have given up the idea that Mayor Broening has any real chance for election," he asserted. "The active Democratic leaders of the city believe that Gov. Ritchie will carry the 48,000 majority which Baltimore gave him in 1928."

Sees Big County Vote.

"From the county standpoint, the Governor will receive the largest majority from any of the congressional districts in the Central Maryland district comprised of Baltimore, Carroll and Harford Counties.

"The Southern Maryland Counties will probably give Gov. Ritchie his second largest majority from a county section of the State, and the Eastern Shore district will add a third majority to the Governor's total State endorsement."

"Only from Western Maryland is there any real possibility of a Broening majority and if the Mayor of Baltimore carries the five Western Maryland Counties it will be only by a scant margin of hundreds. President Hoover carried the Western Maryland district by 28,000 two years ago."

The betting fraternity in Baltimore City reports no Broening money in sight even at three and four odds.

Hilton Tells of Road.

Commissioner Hilton, who comes from the Poolesville-Barnesville district in which the new road lies, told the gathering of details of its construction and its importance to the section.

It is three and seven-tenths miles in length, he said, and 10 feet wide. The cost was about \$8,000 and \$9,000 per mile, of which the owners of abutting property paid 10 per cent.

Representative Collier predicted that Gov. Ritchie will be elected by a majority of more than 100,000 votes. He lauded David J. Lewis, candidate for the House of Representatives from the sixth congressional district and condemned the Republican national administration which he said is to blame for financial depression and unemployment. The Republican policies in respect to tariff and farm relief were subjects of attacks by the Mississippi Representative.

Mr. Hughes welcomed the people gathered for the road opening and urged them to support the Democratic county administration.

MOOSE ORGANIZE

Complete Association of Lodges in Shenandoah Valley.

Special Dispatch to The Star.

STAUNTON, Va., October 25.—Organization was completed here of the Shenandoah Valley Association of Moose Lodges, which was tentatively formed in September. Delegates were present from Lexington, Roanoke, Covington, Winchester, Waynesboro, Charlottesville and Staunton.

Officers elected are: Maj. James Sipolaki, president; W. L. Radford, first vice president; H. T. Warren, Roanoke, second vice president; W. F. Rittinon, Charlottesville, secretary; E. E. Harmon, Covington, treasurer, and C. P. Hollis, Staunton, president.

The association adopted its by-laws.

BYSTANDER SLAIN

Warrant Sworn After Fatality in Dry Raid Fight.

MAGNOLIA, Miss., October 25 (AP).—A bystander, Hunter of Topsham, Ga., was slain in a "dry raid" fight and a warrant was sworn out for the slaying here last night, was sworn out today by District Attorney F. D. Newitt.

A mass meeting held in Magnolia named a committee to request the grand jury be called to investigate the shooting.

WINS ESSAY CONTEST

SPRINGFIELD, Mass., October 25 (AP).—Miss Evelyn Hunter of Topsham, Ga., won first prize in the National Peace Essay Contest for King's Herald and Standard. Her essay, "The Peace of the World," was sponsored by the Women's Foreign Missionary Society, in convention here. The award was made tonight at the young people's banquet.

Ted Micker, editor of Berkeley, Calif., received second prize. The national standard of excellence award was made to Baltimore.

THESE WILL GRACE MANY A THANKSGIVING DAY TABLE



And judging from this flock there should be no scarcity of the regal bird this year. The picture shows just a small portion of the 1,000 turkeys, which have been well fattened for the holidays, on the farm of Mrs. John E. Darby, near Dawsonville, Md. Maryland and Virginia farms generally report an abundance of turkeys. John A. Hicks, Federal-State agricultural statistician, yesterday declared that a survey indicated that the Virginia turkey crop was approximately 5 per cent larger than last year. —Star Staff Photo.

CHANGE IN COUNTY PLAN IS OPPOSED

Opponents of Proposed New Arlington Form: Launch Campaign.

BY LESTER N. INSKEEP, Staff Correspondent of The Star.

CLARENDON, Va., October 23.—Certain opposition to the proposal to change the present form of county government by a vote at the polls on November 3, which heretofore has been devoted to a large extent to a "whispering campaign," today reached the light and is expected to henceforth assume the proportions of a campaign of opposition.

Most of the opposition recorded to date has been with respect to the abolition of the magisterial districts, many of the residents of outlying sections fearing that the election of the members of the county governing body "in large" would result in the selection of all of the members of the board from the thickly settled sections to the neglect of the former.

Against Manager Plan.

Robert H. Forman, executive secretary of the recently organized Voters' Service Club, today announced that he could not go on record as favoring the county manager plan, which is being advocated by the Civic Federation, Chamber of Commerce and Bar Association.

Financially, the plan advocated is likely to prove more expensive than the present, Forman believes. In support of this he points out that the cost of the present form is \$7,500 yearly, consisting of the salaries of the three supervisors of \$1,200 yearly each and that of the county engineer at \$4,000.

"Under the county manager plan," he says, "the proposed salary for each commissioner is \$600, which makes a total for the five commissioners of \$3,000. But, a few years ago, the salary of a supervisor was \$800 and it would be very logical thing for the State Legislature, which increased the salaries of the supervisors to \$1,200, to vote a similar increase in the salary of each commissioner. Thus instead of \$3,000 expended for commissioners' salaries we would have \$6,000. Add to this the engineer's salary at \$4,000 and the county manager's salary, which may be conservatively estimated at \$8,000, and a total of \$18,000 under the proposed plan, an increase of \$10,400 annually in the cost of government."

Time Not Appropriate.

In view of the general economic conditions, he thinks, this is not an appropriate time to experiment with something that is likely to prove more expensive than the present form and that is sponsored by a number of individuals who have had no experience in government.

Abolition of magisterial districts is, in the minds of Capt. Oranall Mackey, Clarence R. Ahalt and other prominent members of the local bar, a direct departure from representative government and should not be tolerated.

It would be just as logical, they point out, to abolish the counties of the State and elect the members of the House of Delegates and State Senate at large and then to go on and abolish the State and elect every member of our National Government at large.

The State Capt. Mackey says, has already given the Boards of County Supervisors the full power of a city council and under this law and other local legislation Arlington County has so advanced that since 1926 it has stood at the head of all of the hundred counties in the State in the amount of revenue paid into the State treasury.

Conditions Declared Different.

Coming to the support of the proposed change, John A. Petty, president of the Livingstone League, declares that Arlington County, due to the fact that it is adjoining the National Capital and is a part of the environs thereof, occupies a peculiar position calling for somewhat different development and administration than commonly is required of counties in general.

The outstanding advantages of the proposed change are listed by him as follows:

1. Wiping out the magisterial districts, thus making Arlington County a single unit.
2. Creating the office of county manager, thus putting in the hands of one person devoting his entire time to county affairs the opportunity to co-ordinate all administrative activities and definitely fix responsibility therefor.
3. Increasing the county board from three to five, provides a wider viewpoint and a larger measure of representation in the executive direction of county affairs.
4. Election at large of the county board gives every voter the right to cast his ballot for or against each of the members of the county board.
5. Specific provision for a county budget with a definite basis for its development and use will afford the citizens of Arlington County individually and through their various community organizations an opportunity of studying in detail county expenditures and presenting their views and extending their co-operation to the officials of the county in the interest of economic and efficient administration.

There is nothing in the law which permits the change to either specific point and a larger measure of representation of Arlington County or not a resident, he says, and he feels no doubt but that a competent man could be elected to the office of "county manager," he says, "one might be obtained from among the present officials of Arlington County."

Two Horses Drown When Man Drives Wagon Into Bay

Vehicle Put in Water to Swell Seams—Driver Nearly Loses Life.

Special Dispatch to The Star.

WOODLAWN, Va., October 25.—Howard Fisher drove his wagon into Gunston Bay to swell the seams which were separating due to the dry weather. Both horses floundered over their depths and were drowned.

Fisher and his companion had a narrow escape from the same fate when the wagon overturned, due to the horses struggling. They held onto a chain on the wagon body and shouted for assistance. They were rescued in a boat by residents of the Summer colony at Gunston Bay.

The accident was investigated by Deputy Sheriff McCann and Justice Harry Shepherd at Accotink, first reports having been to the effect that a man was drowned.

Motorist Killed in Nearby Crash

Ward E. Van Pelt Dies in Hospital—Brother-in-Law Severely Injured.

Ward E. Van Pelt, 41, of Ballston, Va., was fatally injured at Memorial drive and Mulhall road at noon yesterday when his automobile collided with a machine driven by E. L. Loveless of Bon Air, Va. Van Pelt died shortly after being taken to Georgetown Hospital. I. N. Miller, his brother-in-law, was severely injured.

According to Arlington County police, Loveless was entering the intersection when his machine was struck by Van Pelt's car. The latter machine was moving so swiftly, it is declared, that it skidded for a distance of 75 feet before coming to a complete stop.

Loveless, who was on the way to his home at the time of the accident, escaped injury. Sheriff Howard B. Fields said that there would be no arrest, since Loveless is thought not to have been responsible for the accident.

Van Pelt was a native of Harrisonburg, Va., coming to Arlington County three years ago. He was a building contractor and is survived by his widow, Mrs. Alice Van Pelt, and six children, ranging in ages from 3 to 19 years.

FEDERAL FORESTS CLOSED TO PUBLIC

Fire Hazards Due to Drought Cause Closing of Natural Bridge Section.

Special Dispatch to The Star.

LYNCHBURG, Va., October 25.—Unusual fire hazard existing in Arnolda Valley section of the Natural Bridge Federal forests has caused authorities to close the section to the public until further notice, according to announcement made here by H. M. Sears, superintendent of the forests. Mr. Sears indicated that other sections where there have been fires during the prolonged drought may also be closed shortly.

Persons visiting the closed area will be prosecuted as trespassers, Mr. Sears said.

The area is bounded by the Arnolda Valley road on the east and north of the highway through Pettis Gap; between Arnolda Valley road and the top of the Blue Ridge Mountains on the east and between Pettis Gap road and James River on the north.

Authority for closing the district to the public was issued by the regional forester at Washington under regulations prescribed by the Department of Agriculture for administration of national forests.

CHURCH WILL HONOR VETERAN ORGANIST

Sherman Bruce Fowler of Alexandria Served 40 Years for St. Paul's Episcopal Congregation.

Special Dispatch to The Star.

ALEXANDRIA, Va., October 25.—Forty consecutive years as organist and choir director at St. Paul's Episcopal Church will be observed tomorrow by Sherman Bruce Fowler of 316 South Washington street, the organist.

Mr. Fowler became organist and choir director at the church in 1890, after having previously served as organist of Trinity M. E. Church. An elaborate musical program has been arranged for both morning and afternoon services, and many former choir singers of the church will be present and aid in the program.

PROPERTY VALUES RAISED \$25,000,000

Alexandria Assessment Puts Taxable Worth at \$41,000,000.

Special Dispatch to The Star.

ALEXANDRIA, Va., October 25.—Real property of this city has an assessed valuation of approximately \$36,000,000 in the report of the Board of Assessors, which has just completed its work, and with the estimated valuation of \$5,000,000 on public utilities, which valuation is set by the State Corporation Commission, the total valuation here will be approximately \$41,000,000, on which taxes will be based for next year.

Increase \$25,000,000.

The valuation last year was \$16,791,882, which means that the new total valuation will be an increase of almost \$25,000,000 over the former figures. The figures as compiled this year have been based on actual values of the property, while in the past the valuation has been about 25 per cent of true valuation. To offset this the present tax rate of \$2.85 per hundred will be reduced and will probably be placed around \$1.10 by City Council.

The increased valuation represents about 2.6 per cent increase over the former values, and on the basis of the new values the former valuation is revealed as about 28 per cent of true values. A tax rate of \$1.10 on the \$41,000,000 will bring the city an increase of a few thousand dollars over the revenue last year from taxes. The new rate, however, may be placed slightly higher than \$1.10, and if so, the return will be correspondingly greater.

Whatever new rate is established, a special rate will probably be put into effect for residents of the territory annexed last January from Arlington County, as the taxes in that section may not be increased until the next taxation agreement for a period of five years. Property owners in that section paid at the rate of \$2.50 last year, which was 15 cents over the average rate for the remainder of the city.

The new assessment will give the city greatly increased borrowing power, which is based directly on the assessed valuation of real property. It also is expected to aid real estate men, since persons not familiar with the former method of assessing property at a portion of its true value could not reconcile the prices asked for property with the amounts at which it was assessed.

Last year the city budget was \$719,000, which included \$193,560 for school fund and \$90,214 for the fund of the city. The new assessment will be cut out in the new budget, due to the recent sale of the city by the City of Alexandria, which was \$450,000, with the additional revenue coming from the State portion of the school fund, the city automobile license tax, corporation and franchise taxes, licenses, fines and other miscellaneous receipts.

The new figures will be formally presented to City Council at its meeting next Thursday, and at that time it is expected that the new rate will be discussed. The amount of revenue necessary and the amount which will be received from various rates will be figured before the Council arrives at the new tax rate.

The books of the assessors will be first turned over to the clerk of the courts, where they will be opened for public inspection within a few days. Property owners then have recourse to the records and may object to the views if they are not satisfied with the values placed on their property. Final reports will be to the Corporation Court, presided over by Judge William P. Woods. When the Board of Reviews has completed its work and the new tax rate is fixed, the books of the assessors will be permanently placed in the office of the Commissioner of Revenue.

In conjunction with the work of the local Board of Assessors, the city employed the Manufacturers' Appraisal Co. of Philadelphia to aid in the scientific assessment of the city and to make maps and plats of city property. The work has been completed and consists of 260 blue-print maps and plats, which are on file with the city. Copies of these maps also may be purchased by any citizen. A card index system of property also was worked out by this company and this with the new plats, will greatly simplify the work of future assessors.

The Board of Assessors is composed of Taylor Burke, Fred C. Goodnow and Edward J. Fleming. Dates for meeting of the local Board of Review are expected to be announced shortly.

VIRGINIA HOSPITAL PLANS FOR OLD LADIES' HOME

Directors of Lynchburg Institution Take Steps for Establishment of Retreat.

Special Dispatch to The Star.

LYNCHBURG, Va., October 25.—First steps looking to establishment of an old ladies' home at the Virginia Baptist Hospital have been taken by the board of trustees of the hospital. The hospital board decided to sponsor the home, which is to be under separate management, if sufficient funds can be secured for its success. The hospital board will give sites for the buildings needed.

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